

Game Design
Lawyer blahblahblah

Premise: Player is a lawyer in the OJ Simpson murder case (either prosecutor/defense), goal is to win the jurors to win the case. Since the requirements state that the game has to be an adventure/journey, we should include the whole legal process.

40 cards; 12 tokens; 1-2 die;

Card Types:

Must Have:

- Arguments (directly sway jury opinion)
- Tactics (action cards; increase odds, counter the oppositions cards)
- Result of the trial
- Evidences

Could Have:

- Investigation (Manipulates cards you get during investigation phase)
- Pre-trial Motions (Affect the cards played during the trial phase)

Jury Tokens:

- Have 2 different colours to indicate whether the jury is convinced by the prosecutor or the defendant (red and blue?)

Die:

- d10

Representing Legal Process: 3 phases to represent investigation, pre-trial & trial.

Phase 1: Investigation

The player gathers evidence, witnesses, arguments, tactics etc.

Current Idea: The player draws X number of cards, representing building a case. Investigation cards can be played to draw more cards, reshuffle cards, look for more specific cards etc.

Phase 2: Pre-Trial

The player chooses X number of cards to keep, discarding the rest (Preparing arguments, eliminating weak links). Pre-trial motions can be played to manipulate odds of cards in trial, weaken opposition cards, improve odds of winning over jury.

Phase 3: Trial

The player plays their argument cards, rolling dice to win over the jury. Cards from pre-trial may take effect here, as well as playing tactic cards (e.g. objection, expert witnesses etc) to further manipulate odds of winning the case. After choosing the cards to play, the player will flip card(s?) from the deck to represent the opposing lawyer presenting their own arguments. (This system probably has a lot of room for improvement)

Idea 1: Shared Deck

All cards start in the same deck.

Pros: easy to set up, no need to sort

Cons: becomes difficult to separate cards meant for each phase, makes flipping annoying

If can fit more info on a card we can make non-trial cards dual purpose (cost of visual clarity)

Idea 2: Split Deck

Cards are split between trial & non-trial cards.

Non-trial cards are used for investigation + pre-trial. (investigation + pre-trial motions)

Trial cards are used during the trial itself. (arguments + tactics)

Pros: each phase of play becomes a lot more streamlined since cards for each phase only appear during said phase

Cons: set-up becomes more troublesome since cards need to be split and shuffled separately.

I think idea 2 is better.

Trial phase regarding how the opposing lawyer plays probably needs a lot more elaboration

Need to determine if we want to represent the pros and cons for both prosecutor & defense: more accurate but more complicated.

Also should find out if we need to identify common defense/prosecution strategies.

Charges:

- 2 counts of first-degree murder with special circumstances (special circumstances: actions/condition in which a crime was committed. Allows for more severe punishment)
- Eventually charged for wrongful death in 1997 (had to pay \$33.5 million in damages)

Evidence found:

- Hair of Simpson found on the cap at Bundy residence and on Ron Goldman's shirt
- Simpson has a history of violence directed at Nicole Brown
- Cotton fibers consistent with the carpet in Bronco is found on the glove at Rockingham and on the cap at Bundy residence
- Fibers of Brown's dog were also found in Simpson's estate
- Gloves that were used in the killings did not appear to fit properly on Simpson's hands
- Left hand gloves were found outside Brown's home while the blood stained right hand gloves were found at Simpson's home
- Blood found near shoe prints at Bundy was the same type as Simpson's (0.5% of the population will match)
- Shoe prints of size 12 Bruno Magli shoe found at Bundy residence are of the same size as Simpson's shoe (size 12)
- Store receipts showing Simpson had purchased a 12 inch knife 6 weeks before the murder

- Knife was recovered and determined to be similar to the one that cause the stab wounds but not the exact one as it was still covered in a special oil used on new cutlery indicating it had never been used
- Neighbour's housekeeper Rose Lopez stated she saw Simpson's bronco parked outside his house at the time of the murders but during cross examination she admitted she wasn't sure of the time (She said another housekeeper was there Sylvia Guerra, who later claimed the defense offered \$5000 for them to admit to that)
- Simpson was caught fleeing and trying to get away from the police
- (Civil trial) Simpson had completed a lie detector test after the crime was examined and had failed it

Card split 10 investigation (1-10 spades) , 25 trial(5 argument (clubs 6-10) , 15 evidence (1-5), 5 tactics (diamond 6-10)), 2 result , 3 motion

Gameplay loop:

Jury starts off undecided

Flips to blue/red as game goes

First to 12 wins

If none is 12 by the end, draw

Draw 5 cards from pretrial

Draw 5 cards from trial

Have all 3 motion cards at hand

Have all 5 tactic cards at hand

In phase 1, can use investigation cards to manipulate hand

In phase 2, pick 1 motion card, each having a specific effect on the game

In phase 3, attempt to get all 12 jury tokens on ur side before using all cards to win

Cards:

Pretrial Motion:

1. Motion to suppress:

a. Pros: All opposing evidence will be suppressed(roll d10 dice, if >5, opposing evidence will not be used.

b. Cons: If opposing evidence ends up being used, that evidence check get a +15% chance of succeeding

2. Motion to dismiss:

a. Pros: Attempt to dismiss all opposing arguments,(roll d10 dice, if >5, opposing argument will not be used)

b. Cons: For each opposing argument used, player checks will receive a 5% penalty. (meaning if i have 5 arguments that fail the roll and end up being used, player checks will have a 20% penalty)

3. Motion for continuance:

a. Pros: Reshuffle and draw up the current number of cards in hand + 5 extra cards.

Pretrial Motion:

4. Motion to suppress:
 - a. Pros: All opposing evidence will be suppressed(player evidence get +5 bonus)
 - b. Cons: if the evidence roll fails, the opposite effect is applied. (meaning +2 to player will become -2 to player)
5. Motion to dismiss:
 - a. Pros: Attempt to dismiss all opposing arguments, chances of opponent arguments winning is halved.
 - b. Cons: For each opposing argument won, player checks will receive a -1 penalty to everything. (meaning if players lose 5 arguments, , player checks will have a -5 penalty)
6. Motion for continuance:
 - a. Pros: Reshuffle and draw up the current number of cards in hand + 5 extra cards.
 - b. Cons: No other effects

Investigation cards:

Private investigator

- a. Look at top 5 cards of pile, choose 2 to keep, discard the rest

Surveillance footage

- b. Search deck for 1 specific card, add to hand, reshuffle deck

Crime scene sweep

- c. Reveal top 3 cards, keep only evidence cards, discard all argument cards

Paper trail

- d. Discard 2 cards to draw 2 more

Witness interview

- e. Draw a card, if it is an argument card, draw another card,
- f. if it is evidence card, roll dice, if >5, keep, else discard this card and another evidence card of players choice

Police report

- g. Rearrange the top 5 cards on the pile and return them to pile

Anon tip

- h. Take any random card from pile without looking

Lab result

- i. Roll d10 dice, if >5, draw 3 cards
- j. If <=5, discard 1 argument card

Media leak

- k. Reveal top 5 cards, keep only argument, discard evidence

Overtime work

- l. Discard 1 argument card to draw 2 evidence card

Tactics:

1. Objection (unlimited use)
 - a. When opponent card revealed, roll both d10 dices, half the result and apply it as penalty to the check
 - b. If the opponent card still passes, the effect is doubled.
2. Expert witness (once per game)
 - a. Able to reuse another card that has already been played, but only your side will be played, not opponent
3. Plea to emotion (once per game)
 - a. Get 1 jury token, if the opponent has more tokens, get 1 and remove 1 from opponent
4. Surprise witness(once per game)
 - a. Only usable after opponents card reveals, cancels the effect of said card, but player has to discard 2 cards from hand
5. Confidence place (unlimited use)
 - a. Reroll for player if player fails check. If reroll fails again, player has to discard one card from hand

Tactics:

6. Objection (unlimited use)
 - a. When players lose an argument, they can reroll dice. If player loses again, double the penalty
7. Expert witness (once per game)
 - a. Able to reuse another card that has already been played
8. Plea to emotion (once per game)
 - a. Get 1 jury token, if the opponent has more tokens, get 1 and remove 1 from opponent
9. Surprise witness(once per game)
 - a. If the opponent wins, this card can be used to cancel its effects. However, player have to discard 1 card on hand after using this
10. Confidence place (unlimited use)
 - a. Reroll for player if player fails check. If reroll fails again, player has to discard one card from hand
11. Cross-examination(once per game)
 - a. Allows player to use 2 different evidence card this round
12. Exposed bias(once per game)
 - a. Completely ignore this turn(used after turn end)

Argument:

1. Argument 1
 - a. For: History of domestic violence is irrelevant as the past is not the crime
 - i. Roll dice, if 80% or higher, 1 opposing jury becomes neutral while 1 neutral jury joins the player. If this card is played right after abuse evidence, double its effect.

- b. Against: History of domestic violence shows pattern of abuse
 - i. Roll dice, if 25% or higher, 1 jury (should this be neutral or the player's side?) joins the opposing. If this card is played right after abuse evidence, double its effects.
- 2. Argument 2 (not sure if it is too specific? Or should this be used as evidence?)
 - a. For: Unfitting gloves cannot be blamed on arthritis medication since it is taken daily
 - i. Roll dice, if 60% or higher, 2 opposing jury becomes neutral while 1 neutral jury joins the player.
 - b. Against: Unfitting gloves is due to intentional forgoing of arthritis medication
 - i. Roll dice, if 85% or higher, 1 opposing jury joins the player.
- 3. Argument 3
 - a. For: Crucial evidence found in the crime scene were due to police mishandling of the case
 - i. Roll dice, if 70% or higher, 2 opposing jury becomes neutral while 1 neutral jury joins the player. If this card is played after glove evidence, 1 additional neutral jury joins the player.
 - b. Against: Crucial evidence found in the crime scene all had Simpson's DNA on it
 - i. Roll dice, if 40% or higher, 1 neutral jury joins the opposing. If this card is played after evidence that have Simpson's DNA on it, double its effects.
- 4. Argument 4
 - a. For: Racism in the police force was rather common and resulted in Simpson being framed
 - i. Roll dice, if 75% or higher, 1 opposing jury becomes neutral while 2 neutral jury joins the player.
 - b. Against: Racism in the police force does not tally up with the potential motives and behaviour Simpson displayed before the murder
 - i. Roll dice, if 30% or higher, 2 jury joins the opposing. If this card is played after knife evidence/abuse evidence, double its effects.
- 5. Argument 5
 - a. For: Erratic behaviour from emotional instability can be explained for Simpson's actions
 - i. Roll dice, if 80% or higher, 1 neutral jury joins the player.

- b. Against: Erratic behaviours usually stem from the feeling of guilt
 - i. Roll dice, if 20% or higher, 2 jury joins the opposing. If this card is played after media evidence of Simpson fleeing, 1 additional neutral jury joins the opposing.

6. Argument 6

- a. For: Lack of direct witnesses or murder weapon to the murder case
 - i. Roll dice, if 90% and below, 1 opposing jury joins the player
- b. Against: Murder motives were clear, Simpson was physically capable of acting on it and had access to knives (which was the murder weapon)
 - i. Roll dice, if 30% and above, 3 neutral jury joins the player and 1 opposing jury becomes neutral. If any evidence with Simpson's DNA is played, the opposing turned neutral jury joins the player.

7. Argument 7

- a. For: Crime scene was compromised from the beginning due to media pressure (investigators got distracted by the media)
 - i. Roll dice, if 40% and below, 1 neutral jury join the player, else 1 opposing jury turn neutral
- b. Against: Compromised crime scene does not change the fact that Simpson's DNA was on the crime scene since the media does not have access to Simpson's DNA to be tampered with
 - i. Roll dice, if 55% and above, 1 neutral jury joins the opposition

8. Argument 8

- a. For: Crime scene management was severely lacking (there were free access for command staff walking around the crime scene that creates opportunity for evidence to be planted)
 - i. Roll dice, if 75% and below, 2 neutral jury join the player, else 1 opposing jury joins the player
- b. Against: There is no proof of evidence being planted (DNA results are still valid due to rigorous testing in the lab)
 - i. Roll dice, if 15% and below, 1 opposing jury turn neutral else 1 neutral jury join player

9. Argument 9

- a. For: Potential evidence cross-contamination since the crime scene is compromised
 - i. Roll dice, if 10% and above, 1 neutral jury joins the player and 1 opposing jury turn neutral

- ii. If evidence cross-contamination card is played after this argument, 1 more neutral jury join the player

b. Against:

10. Argument 10

- a. For: LAPD rules by terror since their police department is smaller than other departments in areas that are of similar size to Los Angeles; evidences were collected via illegal means such as climbing over the wall of people's home (Bad reputation of the LAPD)
 - i. Roll dice, if 60% and above, 2 opposing jury turns neutral else 1 neutral jury joins the player
 - ii. If this argument card is played after argument 3 (police mishandling of the case), 1 additional neutral jury joins the player

b. Against:

Evidence:

1. Evidence 1

- a. For: Phone call logs to 911, diary entries, witness testimonies
 - i. Roll dice, if 80% or higher, 1 jury joins player, if 20% or lower, 1 jury joins the opposition.
 - ii. If played right after the argument card, the argument card gets played again(only for the player's side).

2. Evidence 2

- a. Left hand gloves found on the murder scene while the blood-stained right-hand gloves are found in Simpson's estate
 - i. For: Roll dice, if 60% or higher, 1 jury joins the player, if 30% or lower, 1 jury joins the opposition, if between 30% to 60%, the jury remains neutral
 - ii. If this card is played after argument 3, 1 additional jury joins the player

3. Evidence 3

- a. Hair fibers of Brown's dog and cotton fibers of the carpet in Bronco were found in Simpson's estate (should group all the fibers together? -> hair of Simpson's was also found on the cap at Bundy residence and Ron Goldman's shirt)
 - i. For: Roll dice, if 65% and above, 1 jury join the player, if 40% and below, 2 jury join the opposition
 - ii. Against: Roll dice, if 80% and below, 1 jury join the player

4. Evidence 4

- a. Simpson has a history of violence directed at Nicole Brown
 - i. For: Roll dice, if 20% and below, 1 jury join the player, else 1 jury join the opposition
 - ii. Against: Roll dice, if 40% and above, 1 jury join the player
 - iii. If this card is used after argument 1, 1 additional jury join the player

5. Evidence 5

- a. Blood found near the shoe prints at Bundy residence is the same type as Simpson's
 - i. If this card is used after argument 3, the dice rolled have to add an additional 10% to it

6. Evidence 6

- a. A Bruno Magli shoe print of size 12 was found at Bundy residence; Simpson's shoe size is also size 12
 - i. For: Roll dice, if 25% and below, 1 jury join the opposition
 - ii. Against: Roll dice, if 40% and above, 2 jury join the player

7. Evidence 7

- a. Receipt of a 12 inch knife was found to be bought by Simpson 6 weeks before the murder
 - i. For: Roll dice, if 90% and above, 1 jury join the player
 - ii. Against: Roll dice, if 15% and above, 2 jury join the player
 - iii. If this card is used after argument 5, double its effects

8. Evidence 8

- a. Knife was recovered and determined to be similar to the one that resulted the stab wounds but not exact murder weapon (it was still covered in a special oil used on new cutlery, indicating that it has never been used before)
 - i. For: Roll dice, if 55% and above, 1 jury joins the player

9. Evidence 9

- a. Witness Rose Lopez stated that she saw Simpson's bronco parked outside his house at the time of murder but was not exactly certain of the time
 - i. For: Roll dice, if 20% and above, 1 neutral jury joins the opposition
 - ii. Against: Roll dice, if 70% and below, 1 jury joins the player

10. Evidence 10

- a. Simpson was caught fleeing and trying to get away from the police

- i. For: Roll dice, if 30% or higher, 1 jury joins the player, if 25% or lower, 1 jury joins the opposition
- ii. Against: Roll dice, if 30% or higher, 1 jury joins the player
- iii. If this card is played after argument 5, 1 additional neutral jury joins the player

11. Evidence 11

- a. Witness Sylvia Guerra was near the crime scene as well and claimed that the defence offered \$5000 for them to admit to it
 - i. For: Roll dice, if 40% and above, 2 jury from the player joins the opposition
 - ii. Against: Roll dice, if 20% and above, 1 jury joins the player
 - iii. If this card is used after evidence 9, double the effects

12. Evidence 12

- a. Bloodied sock found (blood was drawn and stored in a vial then poured onto the sock -> evidence tampering)
 - i. For: Roll dice, if exactly 30% then 2 jury joins the player. Else, 1 jury join the opposition
 - ii. Against: Roll dice, if

13. Evidence 13

- a. Crime scene technicians were seen collecting evidence without gloves, placing evidence in hot vehicles for hours (evidence cross-contamination)
 - i. For:
 - ii. Against:

14. Evidence 14

- a. Recorded interviews from the prosecuting lawyer consisting of racial discrimination and bragging of planting evidence at a crime scene. Leading to discredibility of the prosecution side.

15. Evidence 15

- a. Simpson had an unclear window of time (~45 mins) before his flight to Chicago during which the murder could have occurred.
 - i. For :Roll dice, if 60% or higher, 1 jury joins the player.
 - ii. Roll dice, if 35% or below, 1 jury joins the opposition.

Playtest Feedback 1:

- Defence only plays when prosecutor plays evidence/arguments
- 7 arguments, all 50/50
 - Each turn, 1 argument is revealed

- Evidence is used to increase odds
- Arguments is its own pile regardless of which side u play
- Change 5 investigation
- Arguments own deck, everything else together

Card split now:

10 arguments, 15 evidence, 3 motions, 7 tactic, 5 investigation (40)

WHAT MUST CHANGE NEOWWWWWW:

- Arguments have a baseline chance (can be skewed either towards prosecution/defence)
- Evidence will add/subtract to the arguments chances (for specific arguments)
- Some Evidence can be used on either side, some are biased towards one.
- Cards that don't favour your side will not negatively affect you (we could make it int you if needed)
- If the hand is empty, you can only roll the arguments.
- Give more ways to optimise card draw during investigation, at end of investigation everything gets discarded

Turn Sequence:

- Flip a card from the argument deck
- Play 1 evidence AND/OR 1 tactic to support your side
- Roll the dice to determine outcome
- Calculate results
- Discard played cards

NEW CARDS

Pretrial Motion:

1.Motion to suppress:

Defense calls for motion to suppress!!

+Evidence gets an additional +1

-If argument fails after using evidence, penalty is 2x

2.Motion to dismiss:

Defense calls for motion to dismiss!!

+Player argument rolls get a +3 bonus

-For every argument the opposition wins, player gets a -1 penalty to all rolls

3.Motion for continuance:

Defense calls for motion for continuance!!

+Reshuffle and draw the same number of cards again. Afterwards, draw 5 more cards

-Nothing

Investigation cards:

Private investigator

Private investigator hired!

-Look at top 5 cards of pile, choose 2 to keep, discard the rest

Surveillance footage

New surveillance footage recovered

-Search deck for 1 specific card, add to hand, reshuffle deck

Paper trail

Discovered a paper trail

-Discard 2 cards to draw 2 more

Police report

Police have delivered their full report

-Rearrange the top 5 cards on the pile and return them to pile

Anon tip

Anonymous tip received!!

-Take any random card from pile without looking

Tactics:

13. Objection (unlimited use)

- a. When players lose an argument, they can reroll dice. If player loses again, double the penalty

14. Expert witness (once per game)

- a. Able to reuse another card that has already been played

15. Plea to emotion (once per game)

- a. Get 1 jury token, if the opponent has more tokens, get 1 and remove 1 from opponent

16. Surprise witness(once per game)

- a. If the opponent wins, this card can be used to cancel its effects. However, player have to discard 1 card on hand after using this

- 17. Confidence (unlimited use)
 - a. Reroll for player if player fails check. If reroll fails again, player has to discard one card from hand
- 18. Cross-examination(once per game)
 - a. Allows player to use 2 different evidence card this round
- 19. Reframed argument(once per game)
 - a. Flip argument odds

History of Domestic Violence

Domestic Violence: +2 to defense

For cards that don't thematically work, they have a trade off (lower chance, more jury)

More card draw for investigation

Number tweaks for both arguments and evidence

Be more specific about synergies

Maybe we can make it persuasion instead of jury count (aim to have a more persuasive case than your opponent)

Synergies in arguments themselves (winning 2 synergistic arguments results in more persuasive)

Different argument/evidence types (social/legal/technical)

Maybe the side we play on is decided after investigation

Make evidence more generically usable

Playtest Results:

1: Pros(5) Def(7)

2: Pros(10) Def(2)

3: Pros(10) Def(2)

bonuses are like this for now

direct - +10(almost a surewin)

circumstantial- roll d20, minus number of arguments loss x2 to the value(if negative, no reward)

credible- +1 to persuasion level for all lvl 1 and 2 in possession

For every success card used, +1 to final score

For every card left on hand , -1 to final score

Chronological timeline of the OJ simpson trial

<https://famous-trials.com/simpson/1863-chronology>

List of evidence used in the trial

<https://www.famous-trials.com/simpson/1857-evidence>

Extensive list of DNA collected

<https://famous-trials.com/simpson/1851-dna>

LAPD Detective racist remarks

<https://www.latimes.com/archives/la-xpm-1995-08-30-mn-40443-story.html>

Consequences of the detective's remarks

<https://www.spokesman.com/stories/1996/oct/03/fuhrman-pleads-no-contest-to-perjury-at-simpson/>